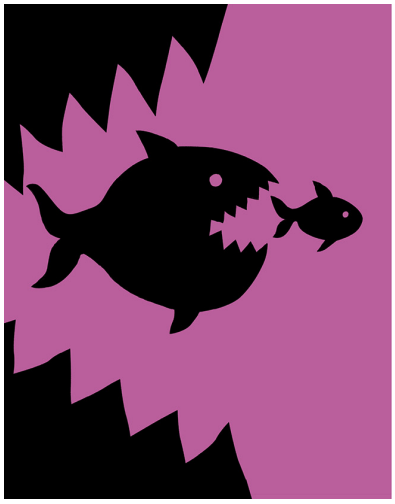


# EVERY DISTINCT PART OF NATURE'S WORKS IS NECESSARY FOR THE SUPPORT OF THE REST

## THE FOOD CHAIN

### IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

**Richard Bradley** (1688–1732)

BEFORE

**9th century** Arab scholar al-Jahiz describes a three-level food chain of plant matter, rats, snakes, and birds.

**1717** Dutch scientist Antonie van Leeuwenhoek observes how haddock eat shrimp and cod eat haddock.

AFTER

**1749** Swedish taxonomist Carl Linnaeus introduces the idea of competition.

**1768** John Bruckner, a Dutch naturalist, introduces the idea of food webs.

**1859** Charles Darwin writes about food webs in *On the Origin of Species*.

**1927** British zoologist Charles Elton's *Animal Ecology* outlines principles of animal behavior, including food chains.

All animals must eat other living things in order to receive the nutrients they need to grow and function. A food chain shows the feeding hierarchy of different animals in a habitat. For example, the chain would show that